Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Modifiers X{EPSU}

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: CP2015100
Related policies: N/A

Effective date: 01/2015
Revision date: 07/2026

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Overview

This policy outlines Humana's billing expectations for reporting Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System (HCPCS) *modifiers XE*, *XP*, *XS* and *XU*, known collectively as *modifiers X{EPSU}*.

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Each one of the *modifiers X{EPSU}* defines a unique subset of distinct procedural services. *Modifier 59* is used to report distinct procedural services more generally without the specificity provided by *modifiers X{EPSU}*. Current Procedural Terminology (CPT®) instructions from the American Medical Association (AMA) state that *modifier 59* should not be used if a more descriptive modifier is available to report the special circumstances.

When one of the *modifiers X{EPSU}* more accurately describes the circumstances of a distinct procedural service than *modifier 59*, Humana encourages the reporting of that modifier, instead of *modifier 59*.

Modifiers X{EPSU} should not be appended to evaluation and management (E/M) services.

Additional Resources on this Topic

Humana's Making it Easier web-based training series includes a video on the proper reporting of modifiers 59 and X{EPSU} that may supplement your understanding of this policy.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Modifier 59:*** Distinct procedural service.
- ***Modifier XE:*** Separate encounter.
- ***Modifier XP:*** Separate practitioner.
- ***Modifier XS:*** Separate structure.
- ***Modifier XU:*** Unusual non-overlapping service.
- ***Modifiers X{EPSU}:*** Modifiers XE, XP, XS and XU, collectively.

References

- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Transmittal 1422, Change Request 8863. Specific Modifiers for Distinct Procedural Services. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Learning Network. MLN Booklet: Proper Use of Modifiers 59, XE, XP, XS & XU. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services HCPCS Level II and associated publications and services.
- American Medical Association's CPT® and associated publications and services.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.

- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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